Topotecan by infusion · small-cell lung cancer

This treatment aims to slow or shrink small-cell lung cancer that has returned after treatment, when repeating the first treatment is not appropriate. Benefit varies; your team explains the aim for you.

Relapsed small-cell lung cancer · NCCP 00311 v4 · Document revised 4 November 2026

Your personal plan: this is the standard regimen schedule. Your team confirms your prescribed doses, cycles, treatment changes and appointments in your written plan.

Small-cell lung cancer guide. Confirm your route and schedule; the intravenous (IV) topotecan protocol also has separate gynaecology indications.

My overall treatment

Topotecan is given by infusion on Days 1–5 of a 21-day cycle. Up to 6 cycles are planned, with earlier changes if treatment stops helping or side effects become unacceptable.

21 day view

Treatment timing in this window

Infusion visits — Day 1–5

Treatment	Review
Infusions on Days 1–5; repeat every 21 days.	Up to 6 cycles; earlier changes if treatment stops helping or toxicity develops.

A typical 21-day cycle

Day 1–5	Day 6–21
Treatment days	Between treatments

Timing may change after review. Side effects can occur on any day; there are no guaranteed safe days.

My tests and checks

When	What is checked	Timing / reason
Before treatment	**Blood count, kidney and liver tests** Required by regimen	Before the first course
During treatment	**Blood count, kidney and liver tests** Required by regimen	Before each cycle
During / after treatment	**Scans, review and any tumour markers** Team-agreed plan	Consultant-agreed dates; no fixed scan or tumour-marker schedule in this regimen

Between treatments

- Blood counts can fall after dosing ends; fever, bleeding or feeling suddenly unwell needs an immediate call.
- Recovery is checked before another cycle; no calendar day guarantees that your counts or symptoms have recovered.

Confirm the exact treatment plan and contact numbers before starting. Have the planned blood tests and tell the team about symptoms and all medicines. Keep the written prescription and symptom record; start the next cycle only after team confirmation.

When to get help

Call 112 / 999 for severe breathing difficulty, severe chest pain, collapse or a seizure.

Call oncology immediately: temperature 37.5°C or above, 36°C or below, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your hospital's temperature instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment. Do not wait for the next appointment.

Oncology daytime: 087 12345678 · **Out of hours:** 087 87654321

EXAMPLE ONLY — team must replace both numbers before patient use.

Feasibility build. Clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Your team confirms your personal plan.

What to watch for

You do not need to know which medicine caused a symptom before calling.

1 Hair / energy

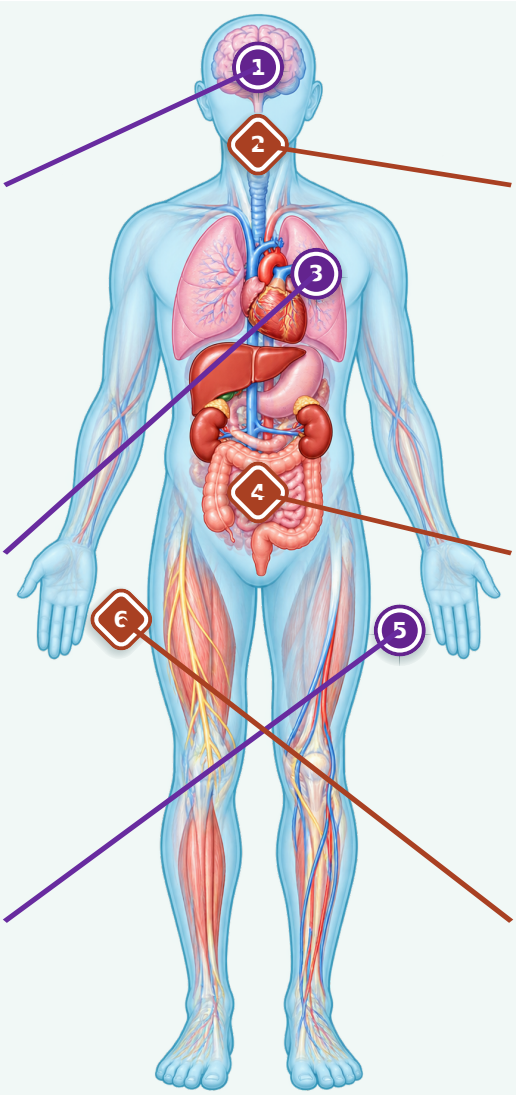
Topotecan

Hair loss and tiredness may occur; report marked weakness or dizziness.

2 Mouth

Topotecan

Tell the team about ulcers or painful swallowing; ask for help if you cannot drink.



3 Chest / breathing

Topotecan

New cough, breathlessness or chest pain needs urgent assessment.

4 Stomach / bowel

Topotecan

Report persistent diarrhoea or vomiting. Fever with severe tummy pain is urgent.

5 Skin / allergy

Topotecan

Report spreading rash; swelling or breathing difficulty needs immediate help.

6 Blood counts

Topotecan

Fever, unusual bruising or bleeding needs an immediate call. The marker is schematic.

Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

Call oncology immediately for fever or suddenly feeling unwell, unusual bleeding, severe tummy pain, persistent vomiting or diarrhoea, or new cough or breathlessness. Do not wait for the next cycle.

When to get help

Call 112 / 999 for severe breathing difficulty, severe chest pain, collapse or a seizure.

Call oncology immediately: temperature 37.5°C or above, 36°C or below, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your hospital's temperature instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment. Do not wait for the next appointment.

Oncology daytime: 087 12345678 · **Out of hours:** 087 87654321

EXAMPLE ONLY — team must replace both numbers before patient use.

Keep your treatment details to hand

Relapsed small-cell lung cancer · NCCP 00311 v4 · Document revised 4 November 2026

Print this page **one-sided on A4 at Actual size / 100%**. Cut only the dashed outer border around both panels. **Do not cut the centre line.** Fold with FRONT and BACK facing out, then glue or tape the blank backs together. Finished size: **85.6 × 54 mm**. Keep the stamp side writable.

FRONT / CONTACTS

My Treatment Card

SACTCheck

Name: _____

Topotecan infusion

Days 1–5 every 21 days; up to 6 cycles

Phase: _____ Planned cycles: 6

Daytime (EXAMPLE) 087 12345678

Out of hours (EXAMPLE) 087 87654321

Unwell or fever? Call oncology now.
Severe breathing difficulty, chest pain or collapse: **112 / 999.**

EXAMPLE NUMBERS — replace before patient use.

BACK / TREATMENT RECORD

My cycle record

Team stamps after each completed cycle.

C1	C2	C3
Date / initials	Date / initials	Date / initials
C4	C5	C6
Date / initials	Date / initials	Date / initials

My treatment information

Plan changed? Ask the team to update this card.

CUT outer border

FOLD centre — do not cut

Keep the record accurate

The team dates and initials each recorded treatment unit when complete. A cycle is complete after its final planned dose; a weekly-treatment stamp records that weekly dose. Delays, omitted doses or a changed plan need a note or a replacement card. A stamp does not approve the next treatment. Keep any medicine-specific alert card too.

Put your treatment page on your phone

Scan your QR and check the treatment name. Save that page to your home screen.

iPhone / Safari

Tap Share → Add to Home Screen. Select Open as Web App if offered, then Add.

Android / Chrome

Tap the three-dot menu → Add to Home screen or Install and create shortcut. Choose the shortcut option and confirm.

Menu wording varies. The QR opens information, not a personal record. Paper stamps do not update the website. Check that the saved icon opens the correct treatment.

Your local contacts and resources

Oncology daytime: 087 12345678 · **Out of hours:** 087 87654321

EXAMPLE ONLY — team must replace both numbers before patient use.

Hospital / team: _____

Backup if the team cannot be reached: _____

Additional local services and resources will be added when confirmed. Your team must check and complete this page before patient use.

Feasibility build. Clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Your team confirms your personal plan.